

Incident ID: BlunkH-20251207  
Date of Report: 2025-12-07  
Report prepared by: Habit Blunk

## 1.0 Executive Summary

This report documents the investigation of a security incident detected on my production network. On 2025-12-07, I found a series of activities from 192.168.0.194. The investigation confirmed that the attacker successfully scanned the network, identified my vulnerable HTTP service, and exploited it to gain admin access to my web page. The incident has been contained, and this report provides a detailed analysis of the event, its impact, and recommendations for future prevention.

## 2.0 Detection and Analysis

- Initial detection: The incident was detected during a post-engagement log review on 2025-12-07. Suspicious connection attempts were noted in the Podman container logs for the DVWA system.
- Systems affected
  - Hostname: DVWA container
  - IP address: 192.168.0.194:8080
  - Function: development server (simulated)
- Source of attack: 192.168.0.194

## 3.0 Timeline of Attack

| Date & Time (UTC)   | Attacker IP   | Description of Activity         | Evidence/Log Source |
|---------------------|---------------|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| 2025-12-07 21:02:28 | 192.168.0.194 | Get landing page                | podman logs dvwa    |
| 2025-12-07 21:05:43 | 192.168.0.194 | Successfully log in as admin    | podman logs dvwa    |
| 2025-12-07 21:17:25 | 192.168.0.194 | Successful login to Cowrie      | podman logs cowrie  |
| 2025-12-07 21:17:46 | 192.168.0.194 | Attempts to get other resources | podman logs dvwa    |

## 4.0 Scope and Impact Assessment

- Scope: The compromise was isolated to the front end part of my DVWA container. Log analysis of my SMB container showed nothing, but my Cowrie container was also probed and logged into.
- Impact
  - Data exfiltration: No evidence of data exfiltration was found. The attacker's actions appeared limited to reconnaissance on the frontend.
  - Data integrity: No files were modified or deleted by the attacker.
  - System access: The attacker didn't achieve a high level of privilege on the container.

## 5.0 Containment, Eradication, and Recovery

- Containment: The Podman network was immediately isolated to prevent any potential lateral movement.
- Eradication: The primary vulnerability was the web app and its Postgres backend. I shut down and removed the container.
- Recovery: I will redeploy the system without DVWA and remove it from the compose YML file.

## 6.0 Recommendation and Lessons Learned

- Immediate recommendations
  - Decommission vulnerable service: The web app and its backend must be permanently removed from the environment.
  - Implement network segmentation: Stricter firewall rules should be implemented to limit access to sensitive ports from untrusted network segments.
- Lessons learned
  - This incident highlights the critical importance of regular vulnerability scanning and patch management. Exposing a service with a known, critical vulnerability provides a direct path for compromise.
  - The use of Cowrie gave the attacker something insignificant to attack but also showed us how the attacker attacks.